



Staff Report

TO: Honorable Mayor and Members of the City Council
FROM: Kari Mendoza, Administrative Services Director
BY: Eric Guzman, Human Resources/Risk Analyst
DATE: July 21, 2026
SUBJECT: Public Hearing on Vacancies to Comply with Assembly Bill 2561

Description: Receive and file a report regarding City staffing vacancies, hiring and retention efforts, and workforce trends in compliance with Assembly Bill 2561 (AB 2561)

Motion:

If the City Council determines that staff's recommendation is appropriate, the following motion is provided:

I move to receive and file the 2026 report regarding City staffing vacancies, hiring and retention efforts and workforce trends in compliance with Assembly Bill 2561 (AB 2561)

Recommendation:

Staff recommends receiving and filing the City's annual workforce vacancy report in compliance with AB 2561, confirming that all represented bargaining units remain below the 20-percent vacancy threshold. The report outlines current vacancies, recruitment activity, employee separations, and retention initiatives, and affirms the City's continued efforts to strengthen hiring practices, improve onboarding, and support long-term employee development. Completing this public hearing satisfies state reporting requirements and underscores the City's commitment to maintaining a stable and resilient workforce that supports effective public service delivery.

Discussion:

The legislative intent of AB 2561 declares the following:

1. Job vacancies in local government are widespread and a significant problem for the public sector, affecting occupations across wage levels and education requirements.
2. High job vacancies impact public service delivery and the workers who are forced to handle heavier workloads, with understaffing leading to burnout and increase turnover that further exacerbate staffing challenges.

3. There is a statewide interest in ensuring that public agency operations are appropriately staffed and that high vacancy rates do not undermine public employee labor relations.

To mitigate these impacts, the law requires agencies to:

1. Report annually on vacancies, recruitment activity, and retention strategies;
2. Identify any policies or practices that may hinder hiring or retention;
3. Provide recognized bargaining groups an opportunity to present during the public hearing; and
4. If any bargaining group vacancy rate reaches or exceeds 20% of authorized positions, provide additional data upon request, including applicant volume, hiring timelines, and efforts to improve compensation, benefits, and working conditions.

Failure to comply with AB 2561 may result in an unfair practice charge. Agencies are obligated to present vacancy information annually or under certain circumstances at the employee organization's request. Employee organizations are allowed to present to the City Council when the vacancy report is presented.

Workforce Overview:

As of July 1, 2026, the City has 284 full-time equivalent (FTE) budgeted positions. Of the 284, 12 are elected or appointed officials. Of the remaining 272 FTE's 82% are represented by bargaining groups. The City's overall vacancy rate is 7%.

Vacancy rates are calculated as follows: Vacancy Rate (%) = (Number of Vacant Positions in an employee group / Total Number of Authorized Positions) X 100. The following table summarizes the City's vacancy rate by employee group as of July 1, 2026.

<u>Represented Employee Groups</u>	<u>FTE's Budgeted/Filled</u>	<u>Vacancies</u>	<u>Vacancy Rate</u>
Police Officers Association	84	4	4%
Police Management Association	5	0	0%
SEIU	119	11	8%
<u>Unrepresented Employee Groups</u>			
PT Temporary Police Cadets	1	3	75%
Executive Contracts	9	1	10%
Manager, Professional, Technical	33	2	6%

<u>Total</u>	<u>251</u>	<u>21</u>	<u>7%</u>
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Vacancies:

POA

- 3 Police Officers – 2 candidates in background process;
- 1 Police Corporal – Promotional review.

SEIU

- 2 Building Grounds Maintenance Worker – 1 candidate in background
- 2 Part-Time Specialists – 2 candidates in background
- 1 Facilities Maintenance Tech – Pending Job Announcement
- 1 Accountant Tech II – Pending Job Announcement/Reclassification
- 1 Records Technician - Reviewing applicants
- 1 Wastewater Operator III/IV/V – Candidate in Background
- 1 Wastewater Collections (New Position) – Reviewing Applications
- 2 Part-Time Bus Driver – Candidates in Background

Unrepresented

- 3 PT Temporary Police Cadets – Pending Job Announcement

Executive Contracts

- 1 Finance Director –Reviewing applicants

MPT

- 1 Planning Manager – Interviews Scheduled 07/21/26
- 1 ACO Project Manager (New Position)

Vacancies within the City arise from a range of factors including retirement, internal promotions, resignations and terminations. Since the last vacancy report presented on May 06, 2025, the City has hired 38 full-time positions and 11 part-time positions (seasonal). Human Resources staff managed 63 recruitments and reviewed 3, 311 applications, demonstrating consistent interest in City employment opportunities.

Employee Separations:

Also since the last vacancy report presented on May 06, 2025, 27 full-time equivalent employees separated from the City. The reasons for departure were as follows:

- 1 employee retired
- 6 employees were involuntarily separated
- 7 temporary seasonal employees were laid off
- 2 Part-time employees left voluntarily for full-time jobs

- 7 employees left for other municipal positions offering higher pay or promotional opportunities
- 1 employee medically retired
- 1 employee left due to the commute
- 1 employee moved out of state
- 1 employee left for the private sector

Employee Retention:

Employee retention remains a central focus of the City's workforce strategy. The City has implemented several initiatives designed to improve employee satisfaction, promote longevity, and enhance professional growth. These efforts include:

- Departmental succession planning
- Completion of Classification and Compensation Study – Individual Job Analysis
- Monthly and or quarterly meetings with represented labor groups
- Enhanced employee recognition programs
- Ongoing professional development through in-person and online training programs through various professional organizations

As part of its workforce planning and in alignment with AB 2561, the City continues to assess internal practices and workforce conditions to identify and address recruitment and retention challenges. Current areas of focus include:

- Exploring new advertising methods and platforms, particularly hard-to-fill positions in which local talent is scarce.
- Reviewing recruitment best practices and improving the onboarding experience

The ongoing self-assessment helps the City become an employer of choice, supports organizational resilience, and ensures the effective delivery of public services.

The City is committed to maintaining a skilled and resilient workforce and to complying with the requirements of Assembly Bill 2561. This report and public hearing fulfill the requirements of AB 2561 and confirm that all represented bargaining units are below the 20% vacancy threshold. The City will continue to monitor staffing trends, address recruitment challenges, and invest in workforce development.

Fiscal Impact:

The cost to prepare this staff report is estimated to be \$694.

Alternatives:

N/A